

observe is the relation in which the great king stands to Marduk of Babylon. The theory of local divinities could not be more emphatically stated. Marduk is angry because Nabonidus, anxious to make Marduk supreme, had removed the shrines and images of the local deities to Babylon, which was his own locality. They in turn are angry at being removed away from their own place. So Cyrus, restoring all to their homes, and establishing Marduk as lord in Babylon, supreme because Babylon itself had such primacy, enjoys the favour of all the gods alike.

Dr Gray seeks for material in the *Cyropædia* of Xenophon, and very acutely points out¹ that its subtle coincidences with our Iranian evidence make its testimony much less negligible than it is usually supposed to be. I think he makes a strong case, but that he has omitted to show how Xenophon bridged the gulf of a century and a half between Cyrus and his own Persian travels. When, on the strength of Xenophon's evidence, which Dr Gray thinks the most reliable we have, the religion of Cyrus is inferred to be nearest to that set forth in the Later Avesta, we note the proof as striking and helpful, but for the religion of Artaxerxes Mnemon rather than that of Cyrus. If we regard Cyrus as probably a Mazdean—not a Zoroastrian, however—it will be because Ahura Mazdah was “god of the Aryans” (p. 32), and Cyrus belonged to an eminently Aryan clan. If it

again and again “King of the Four Regions” (N., S., E., W.), which is an obvious contrast to the Seven Karšvars of the Later Avestan. But of course Cyrus (or his Babylonian secretary) uses the idioms as well as the language of Babylon.

¹ *ERE*, i. 70.